Extension Vision and Philosophy Statement

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Philosophy

Extension is the land-grant promise made concrete: research translated into decisions that improve farm and agribusiness livelihoods. My philosophy is stakeholder-driven and evidence-based. Programs begin with listening—what price, cost, and market questions keep Pennsylvania producers and agribusiness managers up at night—and answer with rigorous analysis delivered in the form decision-makers actually use: outlook briefs, decision tools, workshops, and one-on-one consultation. I measure an Extension program not by activities held but by decisions improved: a producer who hedges intelligently, a lender who prices a loan to the operation's true risk, a cooperative that reads its market position clearly.

This philosophy grows from practice. I design and lead training-of-trainers workshops in applied economics and decision modeling for producers, advisors, and policymakers across 19 countries, and I have seen that the same discipline required of publishable research—clean data, credible methods, honest uncertainty—is what earns a stakeholder's trust. My peer-reviewed research on farm input optimization, farm income risk, farm lending, and technology adoption gives me the subject-matter foundation; my outreach record gives me the delivery craft.

Vision: A Recognized Agribusiness Management Extension Program

Within five years, I will build an agribusiness management Extension program recognized across Pennsylvania and nationally, organized around four pillars:

1. Price and income risk management. Pennsylvania producers face volatile input and output prices with thin margins for error. I will deliver applied programming on hedging with futures and options, crop insurance choices, and whole-farm revenue risk—drawing on my classroom experience teaching *Futures and Options Markets* and my research on farm income and revenue risk exposure. Deliverables: annual outlook workshops, plain-language risk briefs, and spreadsheet decision tools producers can run on their own numbers.

2. Agricultural markets outlook and intelligence. A regular, data-driven market outlook series—grain and livestock prices, input costs, policy developments—distributed through Extension channels and presented at industry meetings, giving producers and agribusinesses a trusted independent read on their markets.

3. Farm financial benchmarking and management. Programming on farm financial statements, benchmarking, and investment analysis, helping producers answer the lender's questions before the lender asks them, and connecting to my research on farm loan packaging and agricultural finance.

4. Economics of smart agricultural technologies. As precision and digital tools spread, producers need independent economic evaluation—what pays, for whom, under what conditions. My research on input optimization and technology adoption, including recent work on AI applications in agriculture, positions me to lead objective, data-driven assessment of these investments.

Delivery will blend in-person workshops, field-day sessions, and online modules that leverage World Campus infrastructure, developed in close partnership with AESE Extension faculty and Pennsylvania commodity groups, cooperatives, lenders, and agribusiness associations. Industry partnership

is not an add-on; it is how programs stay relevant and how applied research questions are discovered.

Funding the Program

A recognized program must be resourced. I bring prior grant experience—a $35,000 award from the U.S. Agency for International Development—and a record of developing funded proposals. I will pursue USDA National Institute of Food and Agriculture programs (including Agriculture and Food Research Initiative and Extension-focused opportunities), Pennsylvania commodity-group and industry partnerships, and state-level applied research funds, sequencing smaller pilot grants into larger multi-year program support. Each funded project will be scoped to serve Pennsylvania stakeholders first while generating publishable applied research, keeping the Extension and scholarship missions mutually reinforcing.

Integration with Teaching and Research

Extension, teaching, and research strengthen one another in my program design. Extension questions—a producer's hedging puzzle, a lender's benchmarking need—become classroom cases in my agribusiness management courses and applied research projects; student analysts contribute to Extension deliverables through supervised projects; and research findings flow back to stakeholders as outlook briefs and tools. This integration is the land-grant model at its best, and it is the program I intend to build at Penn State.